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California Highway Patrol officers arrest a demonstrator on the overpass of the 101 Freeway as protests continued in response to federal immigration operations in Los Angeles on Tuesday.

Los Angeles protests spread to more US cities

TRUMP LABELS PROTESTERS AS ANIMALS, FOREIGN FOES

WASHINGTON

Demonstrations against the Trump administration's immigration crackdown have intensified and spread far beyond Los Angeles, with thousands of people gathering in at least two dozen cities, US media reported.

In Los Angeles, protesters briefly blocked traffic on the 101 Freeway, while in Chicago, large crowds marched through several main arteries of the downtown Loop, briefly halting traffic. Police helicopters hovered overhead as demonstrators walked among stalled buses, and one Chicago Transit Authority (CTA) bus had been tagged with anti-police and anti-ICE (the Immigration and Customs Enforcement agency) graffiti. *The Chicago Tribune* reported no immediate arrests.

Similar scenes unfolded in New York, where blocks of demonstrators marched from Lower Manhattan, near the federal immigration building,

Protests rippled across San Francisco, Seattle, Houston, Dallas, San Antonio, and Washington DC, with varying degrees of police presence and tension.

while in Atlanta, some 1,000 demonstrators lined Buford Highway, with several hundred later marching into Doraville, prompting an immediate standoff with local police.

Elsewhere, protests rippled across San Francisco, Seattle, Houston, Dallas, San Antonio, and Washington, DC, with varying degrees of police presence and tension. According to NBC News, dozens of arrests were reported in New York and San Francisco, while rallies in Houston and San Antonio remained largely peaceful.

In Austin, the local police department issued alerts warning drivers to watch for large groups of pedestrians ral-

lying in support of the Los Angeles protests.

Fiery speech

At an event marking the 250th anniversary of the US Army at Fort Bragg on Tuesday, President Donald Trump delivered a fiery speech, labelling Los Angeles protesters as "animals" and "a foreign enemy." He described their actions as an "invasion" and defended the deployment of approximately 4,000 National Guard soldiers and 700 Marines to the city. Trump vowed to "liberate" Los Angeles and restore it to being "free, clean, and safe," even suggesting he might invoke the Insurrection Act. He further warned that any disruptions during an upcoming military parade in Washington DC would be met with "very big force."

In response, California Governor Gavin Newsom immediately filed an emergency lawsuit in federal court seeking to block the deployment of military personnel for immigration enforcement.

— Agencies
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Indian expat gets special entry stamp 60 years later

Jamaluddin is founder of a school in Dubai

DUBAI

BY CHRISTIAN BORBON
Senior Web Editor

In a heartwarming gesture, Dubai Airports recently fulfilled a son's heartfelt wish, presenting his father with a commemorative airport-entry stamp into Dubai. This special gesture celebrates Haji N. Jamaluddin's remarkable 60 years of contributing to the UAE community since his arrival in 1965.



Jamaluddin, who first arrived in Dubai from Mumbai by ship on February 26, 1965, remembers a city just beginning to take shape. "This new entry stamp isn't just a mark in a passport — it's a tribute to everything Dubai has given us," Jamaluddin said. A respected educator, chairman and founder of Crescent English High School, Jamaluddin has shaped thousands of lives since opening the school in 1984.

Social media fuelling 'devastating' mental health crisis in kids

After Australia, France announces plans to ban social media for children under 15

AMSTERDAM

The "unchecked expansion" of social media platforms is driving an unprecedented global mental health crisis in kids and teens, a children's NGO said yesterday, calling for urgent coordinated action worldwide.

The KidsRights report said one in seven children and adolescents aged between 10 and 19 suffered mental health issues, with the global suicide rate at six per 100,000 for those aged 15-19.

Even these high rates represent "the tip of the iceberg" as suicide is widely under-reported due to stigma, according to the Amsterdam-based group.

"This year's report is a wake-up call that we cannot ignore any longer" said Marc Dullaert, KidsRights chairman.

"The mental health... crisis among our children has reached a tipping point, exacerbated by the unchecked expansion of social media platforms that prioritise engagement over child safety," he added.

'Problematic'

The report said what it termed "problematic" social media use was on the rise, with a direct link between heavy internet use and suicide attempts.

However, blanket bans are not the answer, the group warned.

Australia passed a law to ban social media use for under-16s, while French authorities yesterday announced plans to ban so-

1 in 7

people aged between 10 and 19 suffered mental health issues

6 per 100k

is the global suicide rate for those in the 15-19 age group

cial media for under-15s and the sale of knives to minors after the murder of a teaching assistant by a 14-year-old boy plunged the country into shock.

"Such blanket bans may infringe on children's civil and political rights," including access to information, said the report.

The group urged "comprehensive child rights impact assessments" at a global level for social media platforms, better education for kids, and improved training for mental health professionals.

The report seized on the popularity of Netflix sensation *Adolescence*, which highlighted some of the toxic content kids view online.

The mini-series "demonstrated global awareness of these issues, but awareness alone is insufficient," said Dullaert.

"We need concrete action to ensure that the digital revolution serves to enhance, not endanger, the wellbeing of the world's 2.2 billion children," he said. "The time for half-measures is over."

— AFP

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